

Course: Introduction to Effective Business Communication

6

Basic Listening Skills

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In this lesson, you will be able to:



01

Discuss how to be a better listener

02

Understand reasons for listening

03

Practice the five aspects of active listener

04

05

DISCUSSION

How to be a good (Active) listener? Or

What can you do to become a Active listener?

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THE ART OF LISTENING

“If we were supposed to talk more than listen, we would have been given two mouths and one ear.”

“Mark Twain”

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INTRODUCTION

- ▶ “The basic building block of good communications is the feeling that every human being is unique and of value” (Unknown)
- ▶ Most listener heard about half of the conversation.
- ▶ Miscommunication happened so frequently
- ▶ **Listening** is one of most important skills that you need if you want to communicate effectively
- ▶ Listen is for multiple reasons:
 - ▶ To build relationship
 - ▶ To understand others
 - ▶ To be entertained
 - ▶ To learn
 - ▶ To show empathy
 - ▶ To gather information
 - ▶ ...

HOW TO BE BETTER LISTENER

Self-Awareness:

- ▶ Be aware of your own behavior, feeling and habits when listening.
- ▶ Do you know you are good listener? Are you a good listener in a certain situations: afraid who is upset; tense situation; someone is angry, stressed, or expressing opposition opinion to you...
- ▶ Be aware of your own behavior: at work, at home, with friends, with strangers, or a group.. Notice the following:
 - ▶ Your body language: standing, sitting, tense, or relax, open or closed position
 - ▶ Do you make eyes contact? Keep it, look away, look down, turn eyes to other people/things
 - ▶ Are you following every word>- Repeat verbatim,
 - ▶ Are you planning what you will say in return

HOW TO BE BETTER LISTENER (CONT.)

Active Listening:

- ▶ “You cannot truly listen to anyone and do anything else at the same time”
- ▶ Good listener require improving active listening skills. Pay attention to words that are being said, Concentration and practice,

HOW TO BE BETTER LISTENER (CONT.)

FIVE ASPECTS OF ACTIVE LISTENER

Five aspects of active listener are:

1. Pay close attention:

- ▶ Look the speaker in the eyes
- ▶ Stop any mental chatter
- ▶ Don't start preparing your response while the other person is talking
- ▶ Make sure your environment doesn't distract you
- ▶ Notice the speaker's body language and tone of voice-
What are the non-verbal messages telling you? If you are in a group, avoid side conversation

HOW TO BE BETTER LISTENER (CONT.)

FIVE ASPECTS OF ACTIVE LISTENER

2. Demonstrate physically that you are listening.

Use non-verbal and verbal signals that you are listening to the speaker attentively

- ▶ Nod from time to time, when appropriate
- ▶ Use appropriate facial expressions
- ▶ Monitor your own body language. Be sure you remain open and relaxed rather than closed and tense
- ▶ Use small comments like uh-huh, yes, right

HOW TO BE BETTER LISTENER (CONT.)

FIVE ASPECTS OF ACTIVE LISTENER

3. Check for Understanding

- ▶ Use reflective and paraphrasing. Check that you hear the message correctly by saying things like “What I hear you saying is.....” or “If I’m hearing you correctly, you are saying...”
- ▶ Ask questions that will help clarify speaker meaning e.g. “ Could you tell me more about...” or “What did you mean when you say...” or “I think you are saying..... Is that right?”
- ▶ Summarize what you have heard occasionally

HOW TO BE BETTER LISTENER (CONT.)

FIVE ASPECTS OF ACTIVE LISTENER

4. Don't interrupt!

- ▶ There is nothing good that comes from interrupting the speaker
- ▶ You will only be limiting your chance of understanding the message because you won't hear it all-and because the speaker will get frustrated.

5. Respond Appropriately

When you are actively listening, you are showing your respect for the speaker, and gain information that you need to form your response. When expressing your thought:

- ▶ Be honest and open
- ▶ Be respectful
- ▶ Be thorough

4 LEVELS OF LISTENING



5 BASIC REASONS WE DO NOT LISTEN

- ▶ Listening is Hard Work
 - ▶ Competition
 - ▶ The Rush for Action
 - ▶ Speed differences (120 wpm v/s 360 wpm)
 - ▶ Lack of Training
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IMPROVING LISTENING SKILLS

- ▶ By not being Preoccupied
 - ▶ Being Open Minded & Non-Defensive
 - ▶ Minimizing Interruptions
 - ▶ Effective Listening is: Hearing, interpreting when necessary, understanding the message and relating to it.
 - ▶ By Asking Questions
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LISTENING SKILLS

- ▶ Active Listening
 - ▶ Responding
 - ▶ Paraphrasing
 - ▶ Asking questions for clarification
 - ▶ Mirroring the other person's language
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Additional tips on ACTIVE LISTENING

Few tips towards Active Listening:

1. Understand your own communication style.
 2. Be an active listener.
 3. Use non-verbal communication.
 4. Give Feedback
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ACTIVE LISTENING...(cont.)

1. Understand your own communication style:

- ▶ High level of self-awareness to creating good & long lasting impression on others.
- ▶ Understand how others perceive you.
- ▶ Make others comfortable by selecting appropriate behavior that suits your personality while listening. (Ideally nodding your head).

ACTIVE LISTENING...(cont.)

2. Be An Active Listener:

- ▶ People speak @ 100 to 175 WPM but can listen intelligently @ 300 WPM.
- ▶ One part of human mind pays attention, so it is easy to go into mind drift.
- ▶ Listen with a purpose: **to gain information, obtain directions, understand others, solve problems, share interest, see how another person feels, show support, etc.**
- ▶ If it is difficult to concentrate then repeat the speakers words in your mind.

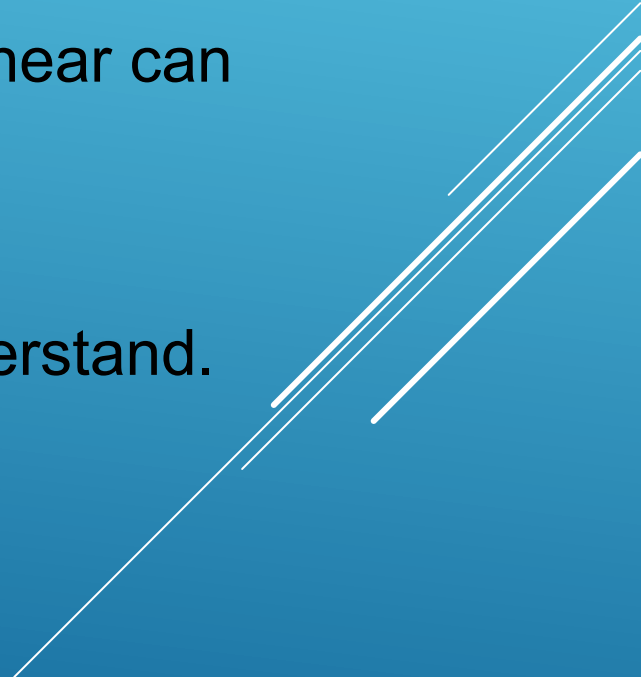
ACTIVE LISTENING...(cont.)

3. Use Non-verbal Communication:

- ▶ Smile,
 - ▶ Gestures,
 - ▶ Eye contact,
 - ▶ Your posture.
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ACTIVE LISTENING...(cont.)

4. Give Feedback

- ▶ Remember that what someone says and what we hear can be amazingly different.
 - ▶ Repeat back or summarize to ensure that you understand.
 - ▶ Restate what you think you heard and ask, "Have I understood you correctly?"
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AFTER WATCHING VIDEO PLEASE DISCUSS AMONG
YOUR TEAM AND RESPONSE TO BELLOW QUESTIONS.
YOUR OUTPUTS COUNT

- ▶ What are the main points you impress the most or your take aways message? Why?
- ▶ Why active listening matter in Business communication?

